KEXIN QUE

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EDUCATION

Graduate student, Northwestern University *Sept. 2023 — June 2028 (Expected)*
Advisor: Dr. Dedre Gentner

BSc (Hons) Psychology, University of Bath *Oct. 2017 — June 2021*
Graduated with First-class honors
Thesis project: People Infer Higher Reward from Less Probable Action: The Trade-off Reasoning between Reward and Probability in Action Understanding
Advisor: Dr. Shari Liu (Mentor), Dr. Elizabeth Spelke (Supervisor), Dr. Richard Joiner (Supervisor)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Analogical Reasoning, Number, Numeral System, Language and Cognition

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Cognitive Science Graduate Fellowship, Northwestern University, 2026

Student Travel Award, Cognitive Science Society, 2026 ($1000)

Student Research Fund, Department of Psychology, Northwestern University, 2026 ($1000)

Cognitive Science Conference Travel Grant, Northwestern University, 2024 ($500)

PUBLICATIONS

Que, K., Gentner, D. (in prep). Analogical processes in number learning.

Que, K., Rips, L. (in prep). Understanding number words across languages: Part linguistic, part arithmetic.

Que, K., Zhang, Y., Christie, S. & Levine, S. (in prep). Cultural Similarities and Differences in the Emergence and Development of Children's Math Attitudes.

Que, K., & Gentner, D. (2026). Using Analogical Comparison to Reveal the Structure of the Count List. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 48).

Que, K., & Rips, L. (2026). Two Distinct Processes in Understanding Number Word Structure. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 48).

Zhang, Y., Sorapuru, J., **Que, K**., Ateek, C., & Le Roux, A. (2026). Meaning and Motivation: How Purpose, Learning Strategies, and Self-Control Relate to Academic Functioning in Higher Education. In *Frontiers in Education* (Vol. 11, p. 1818558). Frontiers.

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, Tan, Z., Zhang, Y., & Christie, S. (2022). Analogy Use in Parental Explanation. *In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 44, No. 44).

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, & Christie, S. (2022). On the Question of Children's Questions. *Early Childhood Development*, 1, 24-35. (in Mandarin)

PRESENTATIONS AND POSTERS

Que, K., & Gentner, D. (2026). Analogical processes in number learning. Invited talk at MesoLab, Indiana University, Bloomington.

Que, K., & Gentner, D. (2026). How do children learn the meanings of small number words? Invited talk at the Experimental Meaning Group Syntax and Experimental Linguistics Lab, Northwestern University.

Que, K., & Rips, L. (2026). Why isn't "twenty-eight" "ten ten eight"? Talk presented at the Biennial Conference on Experiments in Linguistic Meaning, University of Pennsylvania.

Que, K., & Gentner, D. (2026). Using analogical comparison to reveal the structure of numbers. Invited talk at the Developmental Psychology Program, University of Chicago.

Que, K., & Gentner, D. (2025). How do children come to understand numbers? Poster presented at the Developmental Sciences Cluster, Northwestern University.

Que, K., & Rips, L. (2025). Cross-linguistic similarities and differences in people's understanding of the structure of number words. Poster presented at the 2025 Cognitive Science Society Conference, San Francisco.

Que, K., Zhang, Y., Christie, S., & Levine, S. (2025). Family math attitudes and children's views on effort and enjoyment: Cultural differences and similarities. Poster presented at the Society for Research in Child Development Conference, Minneapolis.

Zhang, Y., **Que, K.**, Levine, S., & Christie, S. (2024). Enjoyment or effort: Math learning goals and decision making in two cultures. Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Conference, Pasadena.

Srinivasan, A., Topaloglu, S., **Que, K.**, İleri, C., Küntay, A., Christie, S., Snedeker, J., & Spelke, E. (2024). Does language shape children's understanding of numerical concepts? Talk presented at the 14th Annual Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development, Budapest, Hungary.

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, & Christie, S. (2023). Explaining with spontaneous analogies. Invited talk at the 20th Biennial EARLI Conference, Thessaloniki, Greece.

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, Tan, Z., Zhang, Y., & Christie, S. (2022). Analogy use in parental explanation. Talk presented at the 2022 Cognitive Science Society Conference (online).

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, Tan, Z., Zhang, Y., & Christie, S. (2022). Analogy use in parental explanation. Talk presented at the Analogical Minds seminar (online).

MENTORSHIP

Emma Shuford, Northwestern University, 2024–present
Emily Espinosa, Northwestern University, 2025–present
Maya Liffgens, Northwestern University, 2026 Fall–present
Nick He, University of Chicago, 2026 Fall–present

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant Fall 2023 — Fall 2025

· Social Psychology (Fall 2025, with Dr. Dan Molden); Developmental Psychology (Spring 2025, with Dr. Sara Broaders); Statistical Methods in Psychology (Fall 2024, with Dr. Mike Bailey); Learning, Representation, and Reasoning (Spring 2024, Spring 2026, with Dr. Dedre Gentner); Introduction to Neuroscience (Winter 2024, with Dr. Robin Nusslock)

Part-time Tutor March 2018 — May 2019
Educate.co *Online*

· IGCSE Physics, A-level Mathematics, and Further Math

RESEARCH SKILLS

Designing experiment	PowerPoint, Keynote, Qualtrics, iMovie, and PsychoPy
Coding experiment	Datavyu and Boris
Analyzing data	R, Excel, SPSS, and Excel